

Rep. Tom Emmer on The Matt Gaetz Show

Podcast

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MATT GAETZ:

We have the number three man in the House of Representatives, Whip Tom Emmer, with us at the top of the show to talk Iran amnesty and the rise of socialism on the campaign trail. Plus, we've got the latest tranche of UFO releases from the Department of War. Photos taken from the spaceship Columbia are now unexplainable, according to the head of NASA. We'll go through those images and transcripts that are setting the UFO community on fire. Plus, New York City Councilwoman Vicki Palladino is here with the latest on the attack on the federal building in the Big Apple. And pollster Richard Barras had his data just shared by President Trump. We'll get into what it all says this hour. It's all next on The Matt Gaetz Show. Let's do this. We're shaking up Washington, D.C. We're breaking the fever. You ever watch this guy on television? He's like a machine. He's great. Matt Gaetz.

MATT GAETZ:

Over the weekend and into today, the military conflict between the United States and Iran is intensifying significantly. It's entering its ninth consecutive day of renewed hostilities. The president has said a 10th day is definitely forthcoming. Now, the video here shows a bombardment from the United States of IRGC command and control assets. This was triggered by the recent combat deaths of three U.S. service members. U.S. Central Command deployed fighter jets and Tomahawk cruise missiles against critical strategic assets within Iran. Operations expanded geographically to strike coastal surveillance, air defense networks, and fortified underground missile facilities near Tabriz. We also saw command zones hit near the Bashar civilian nuclear power plant. These extensive American campaigns represent a severe escalation designed to degrade Tehran's strike capabilities. Now, Iran had something to say about all this as well. In immediate retaliation to these strikes, Iran bypassed direct engagement with Israel, and they went on to target U.S. assets and allied Arab nations across the Gulf. Within the last 48 hours, Iranian missiles and drones struck Bahrain and a vital power plant and water desalinization plant in Kuwait. That happened for the second straight day in a row. Here's the scene in Kuwait at the Al Sabaya power station and desalinization plant. There's even talk we're hearing within Iran of a possible ground invasion of Kuwait. Iranian ballistic missiles were raining over Jordan. This turned fatal for two American troops. Iran's deadly missile campaign is prompting midair interceptions and forcing Israel to place its southern defense sectors on the highest alert. Simultaneously, the confrontation over the Strait of Hormuz has brought commercial shipping to a total standstill. The United States Navy continues to enforce a very strict naval blockade. The forceful boarding of non-compliant vessels is happening now. And while Iran's IRGC is claiming responsibility for destabilizing tankers, we are seeing the whole area turned into a very close quarters war zone. Footage emerging from today shows several of the commercial vessels in the Straits engulfed in flames after being attacked by the IRGC off the coast of Oman. One of them is reportedly a Saudi-linked oil tanker. The context of these fast-moving events point to some pretty severe global implications. Economically, choking off the Strait has triggered immediate shocks in the energy markets. Global crude prices have surged past \$90 a barrel, driving U.S. domestic gasoline prices up over \$4 a gallon. Geopolitically, both Washington and Tehran are in this escalatory trap where domestic political pressures in both countries are

preventing them from a deal without looking weak or like they're backing down. Now, although the United States and Iranian officials are quietly acknowledging there is some back channel through Qatari mediators, the margin for error for diplomacy has really narrowed dramatically. The transition from target-specific deterrence to systemic infrastructure warfare is a very important thing to note. If you are wondering what chapter we are in, we are past just targeting the pure military targets. Iran hitting desalinization plants, the United States going after energy infrastructure. It places the entire Middle East on the precipice of a broader regional war.

MATT GAETZ:

Now, in moments, we'll speak to House Majority Whip Tom Emmer about the ongoing war. Here at home, the force that's on the march isn't Iran, it's Democratic socialism, even in our nation's capital. Just last week, D.C. Councilwoman Janice Lewis-George, an avowed Democrat socialist, won the Democratic primary and is going to become D.C.'s next mayor. Can you imagine that? D.C. falling to socialism. There are smart Republicans in Congress trying to fortify against what socialism would bring, high taxes and despair. Oversight Chairman James Comer has filed legislation to give Congress more control over D.C., especially economic policies. At the same time, we are hearing that a bipartisan group of lawmakers on Capitol Hill is cooking up an amnesty bill for illegal alien farm workers. This is at a time when Republicans are controlling the House, the Senate and the presidency. We have 47 Republican lawmakers not pushing for more mass deportations, but instead actively working with Democrats to keep illegal aliens in the country.

MATT GAETZ:

Joining us now is the House Majority Whip, Tom Emmer. Whip, thanks so much for joining us. I want to start on immigration enforcement. Your governor, Governor Tim Walz, is releasing people who are dangerous, who are harming children. How are Minnesotans reacting to this?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Not well. You're talking about Tim Walz, I would argue the worst governor in the country. He would have been an awful vice president. Tim Walz pardoned a illegal alien, Matt, who repeatedly raped a 10-year-old girl. He was tried and he was convicted. By the way, one of his defenses when it started was this is what they do in his culture. Well, I tell you what, you're American. It doesn't happen in this culture. And quite frankly, I think he should consider him lucky that even though Tim Walz pardoned this guy, and Minnesotans are not pleased with it. In fact, the prosecutors were arguing against that from the get-go. Marco Rubio and Donald Trump, God bless him, sent this guy out of this country. Quite frankly, he got lucky because he probably should have gotten the death penalty for what he did to this young girl.

MATT GAETZ:

No question about it. Now, we are seeing voters want that strong immigration enforcement that President Trump has brought to bear, but we are hearing reports of a bipartisan push to create some sort of amnesty structure around industrial farms. What can you tell us about that? Do you think the votes are there and would you support that concept?

REP. TOM EMMER:

No, no. And I've got to read it before I can comment on the specifics, Matt. But I do trust you because you've been doing this for a while. By the way, it's nice to see you wearing a tie.

MATT GAETZ:

Well, I'm not wearing a tie.

REP. TOM EMMER:

It's good that you are carrying on. This is not going to happen. What I do know is this. 14 months now, our southern border has been sealed thanks to Donald J. Trump and Republicans. And this is exactly what the American people asked for. This is what they wanted. We do not have a labor problem. We have a law problem. You want to come to this country? There are ways to do it legally, Matt. We've got ways to do this that you can come to this great country. You can chase your American dream. Quite frankly, the next thing we got to start attacking is the fraud issue that comes with this illegal immigration. And by the way, it even comes with legal immigration. Allegedly, when you talk about the Somali fraud in the state of Minnesota, and I stand by what I said a couple of weeks ago, I don't care where you're from, Germany, Ireland, Poland, Somalia, wherever you come from, we will celebrate your culture. But you come to this country because you are coming to be an American, Matt, an American first. If you don't want to assimilate, then you should get the hell out of here and go back to wherever you came from. You come here to be an American. You don't come here to try and change America to some dysfunctional utopia that you come from.

MATT GAETZ:

You mentioned fraud being a traveling cousin of some of these illegal immigration networks. I would just caution the reported 47 Republicans who've teamed up with Democrats for this farm amnesty bill. If they do that, every NGO will have a farm. NGOs will just have fake farms. There'll be as much farming at the NGO farms as there was learning at the leering centers. Please do not invite that. Now, I do want to get your reaction to President Trump's big primetime speech on foreign interference and election integrity. It really seemed like a lot of that speech was his direction to Homeland Security, the Department of State, the Department of Justice. But was there a specific direction you took from that for the House of Representatives? I know you've got Representative Kamek has bills that deal with Chinese influence. There are a number of them floating around your caucus. Do you think there'll be a legislative push in the House to be a force multiplier to the president's direction to the administration?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I actually hope so. I mean, there's nothing wrong with election integrity. What's wrong with our system is these left-wing media outlets who want to pretend that it doesn't happen, want to pretend that it's not real. President Trump laid it out for us the other night. We should never have our adversaries interfering with our elections. But I know this, Matt. I come from the state of Minnesota where we always, you know, it's Lake Wobegon. They always want to be a little bit better than the average. Well, I tell you what, our secretary of state is refusing to provide the voting records from our last few elections to the federal government. The state is charged with administering federal elections, Matt. You know this full well. When the federal government asks to see your homework, they're entitled to your homework. If our secretary of state didn't have anything to hide, he'd be presenting that information already, and yet he refuses. He's making the federal government sue him. I think this is part and parcel to what our great president talked about the other night when he was talking about Chinese interference and others. It's also right here in our own backyard with people like the secretary of state of Minnesota and our failed governor trying to pretend that there isn't a problem, when in fact we all know there's a problem.

MATT GAETZ:

Well, I know you know what's coming in the House because you're the one who has to count the votes. You're the one who has to tell the speaker and the majority leader what the art of the possible is. And I actually think

on some of this election integrity stuff, you might be able to peel off a Democrat or two if it is basic, straightforward, the stuff you guys have been working on, I think very admirably. I do want to draw your attention overseas to the war with Iran. Tragically, we had more casualties over the weekend. Are you planning to sell to voters in the upcoming midterms an ongoing war?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, you got to give our president credit yet again, right? He may have been saying since it started several months ago, this is going to be over soon. This is going to be over soon. And it was taking longer, Matt. He also told everybody in America that the second we get this done and the straight opens up again, you will see gas prices tumbling down. Well, guess what? He took the bold move to try and reach a settlement, not the kind of settlement we've seen by his predecessors, where you give these Iranian thugs with the IRGC whatever they ask for and allow them to continue down their merry way in developing nuclear weapons. No, he wanted a real settlement that would guarantee peace in the region and around the world. And look, they violated that. But Americans, in the meantime, saw what he said was true. As soon as the straight is open, you will see those gas prices tumble down. And Matt, I think the president made his point. The Iranians violated the terms of the deal that they had. And he's taking them to task now.

MATT GAETZ:

Well, they would say, look, I get it. I get it. Iran has done terrible things. No one's defending Iran. Iran would say they were prepared to abide the MOU. But the strikes from Israel into Lebanon never stopped. It was very clear in the MOU. Israel had to stop bombing Lebanon. They never did. Then Iran didn't hold up their end of the deal. And now here we are. And we can't dissect every cause. But I do want to ask about looking forward. Looking forward, you're either preparing for a midterms where you're pointing to the terrible people the Democrats want to let into the country or pardon, like Governor Walz, you're pointing to an economic agenda from the one big, beautiful bill that is starting to give Americans more buying power. Or you're going to be pointing to a war. And I mean, the MOU you just talked about was popular. Sixty percent of the country supported it. I supported it. The president supported it. But this war seems less popular. Do you think it will get more popular over time?

REP. TOM EMMER:

No, I don't think the war will. But that's where I was going. And I do appreciate you clarifying it for me. I was using too many words. But the bottom line is people now know that what the president was talking about is true, Matt. I don't think the war itself will get more popular. But I do think the president trying to get it to a conclusion so that we can get the straight back open and get commerce start moving again. People will look forward to that. And then it really is about real wages are rising faster than inflation. People are going to have more purchasing power. People are starting to feel the benefits of the bill that was signed into law more than a year ago now. And I think that's going to bode well for us come November, Matt.

MATT GAETZ:

Final topic, Cuba. Marco Rubio released today a report on Cuba's malign influence throughout the Americas, really casting them as the principal villain in this hemisphere. You were the leader of the effort to normalize relations with Cuba to get rid of the embargo. I often thought the conversations that you started around that legislation were really thoughtful and important for the country to have. Do you stand behind Secretary Rubio's findings? And do you still believe the embargo should go away?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, well, the embargo is it only hurts the people that you're trying to help. It's the thugs that run the Castro's and that Castro LLC that runs this thing. What I love, first off, Matt, Marco Rubio is the absolute right guy to be doing this this job. But what I get a kick out of is these the Castro LLC. They think they're much bigger than they are. This is a little island nation that can't even feed itself. And yet they think they're somehow a big player. You know what? They were nothing more than the redheaded stepchild. Not fair to redheaded stepchildren, but of the the Russians and the Chinese and those that would take advantage. They have been a problem for years. And, you know, we're finally holding them accountable again. I think Marco Rubio is the right guy. And this president, as you know, Matt, he makes decisions. He doesn't sit back and do what his predecessors did, which is wring their hands and go, oh, boy, what are we going to do? He makes a call for better or worse. And we move forward. When it comes to Cuba, I think he's doing the right things.

MATT GAETZ:

Tom Emmer, the number three man in the House of Representatives. He counts the votes. I once voted for him to be speaker of the House very proudly. Tom, thanks so much for joining us.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you, Matt. I can see the transcript segment you're referring to appears to be empty or blank in your message. Could you please share the actual transcript text that needs speaker labels added? Once you provide the content, I'll format it with the appropriate ****MATT GAETZ:**** and ****REP. TOM EMMER:**** labels while preserving all original text exactly.

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